

Question 57 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two reasons for evaluating training at more than one Kirkpatrick level.

Introduction

One level, especially reaction only, cannot tell whether training was effective. For 8 marks, two reasons in depth, then supporting reasons. The two strongest: different levels answer different questions; and several levels are needed to diagnose where the chain broke.

Detailed points

1. First reason — different levels answer different questions. Reaction asks ‘did they like it?’ Learning asks ‘did they get the KSA?’ Behaviour asks ‘do they do it at work?’ Results ask ‘did the organisation benefit?’ Liking is not learning; learning is not doing; doing is not always business results. Evaluating at only one level answers only one of these questions and then pretends it answered all. That is why more than one level is needed.

2. Example for the first reason. A fire-safety course can be popular (level 1) while people still cannot use an extinguisher (level 2). Or they can pass a test (level 2) and still not follow procedure on the shop floor (level 3). One number cannot stand for effectiveness.

3. Second reason — diagnosis of failure so HRD can improve. If you only know that ‘performance did not improve’, you do not know whether to change content, trainer, transfer climate, or the original diagnosis. Multi-level data show the break. High reaction + low learning → redesign method. High learning + low behaviour → fix bosses and job conditions. This diagnostic purpose is why the cycle includes evaluation.

4. Accountability reason. Organisations fund training for performance, not for entertainment. More than one level is needed to be honest with those who paid in money and lost work time.

5. Avoiding false positives and false negatives. High reaction can hide zero performance change (false success). Low reaction (strict trainer, hard practice) might still mean high learning (false failure if you only measure smiles). Multiple levels protect employees and HRD from both errors.

6. Employee development reason. Learning and behaviour data guide further coaching of the same people. Evaluation is feedback to the learner, not only a report to the board.

7. Strategic HRD reason. Only higher levels show contribution to organisational goals. If HRD wants strategic status, it cannot live on level 1.

8. Exam wrap. Two reasons as long paragraphs with examples, then accountability, false success/failure, learner feedback, strategy. Conclusion: multi-level evaluation is how HRD tells the truth.

Conclusion. Two main reasons: (1) each Kirkpatrick level answers a different question, so one level cannot define effectiveness; (2) several levels are needed to diagnose where training failed so that HRD can improve. Add accountability and avoiding smile-sheet illusions. Evaluating at more than one level is a professional necessity.